WESTMETRO

Valencia Agro Nigeria Limited

Commercial Proposal for Helium™ Middleware Integration

SAP – FIRS e-Invoicing (MBS) Compliance Enablement
Client-Hosted Zero-Touch Compliance Layer
Prepared By: WestMetro Limited (WML)
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Confidential – For Valency Agro Internal Review Only

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1. Executive Summary

Valency Agro Nigeria Limited requires a secure, low-friction, and audit-ready compliance strategy for the Federal Inland Revenue Service (FIRS – Merchant Buyer Solution, MBS) mandate.

Given Valency Agro's SAP environment—managed by an external SAP partner with an ABAP team based in India—WestMetro Limited (WML) recommends a **Client-Hosted Helium™ Middleware deployment**, where:

- Helium sits entirely inside Valency Agro's environment.
- Valency's **SAP ABAP team** is responsible for **data readiness and enablement**, including implementing **robust, fail-safe queuing** of outbound invoices so that **no invoice is ever lost**, with WML providing architectural and technical guidance.
- Manual invoice push from SAP (via the ABAP team) is fully supported and aligned with Valency's internal control preferences.

This provides:

- Zero-touch compliance automation **without** giving WML direct access to transactional data.
- Full support for IRN generation, QR Code generation, validations, retries, error logs, and immutable audit trails.
- Full master-data alignment via periodic product & customer catalog uploads (handled by Valency's team).
- A predictable & small-footprint implementation path, ideal for your invoice volume and SAP governance model.

WML's **Helium™ Middleware** sits entirely within Valency Agro's controlled environment. It sends invoices to FIRS, receives acknowledgments, ensures data integrity, provides long-term auditability, and supports multiple document types depending on tier.

WML's consultation focus for Valency Agro will be:

- Enabling **expanded FIRS document types** (beyond basic commercial/debit/credit notes)
- Structuring **audit trails** and immutable logs for stronger compliance posture
- Handling multiple **tax categories** (VAT, WHT, surcharges, levies)
- Supporting **HSN mapping** and product categorisation as part of compliance design.

To accelerate compliance, WML will also provide **free stop-gap FIRS bulk-upload tools** so that Valency Agro can achieve basic MBS compliance within **~1 week**, while the full Helium™ Middleware implementation is completed over **6–8 weeks from receipt of the first tranche payment**.

Valency Agro requires a compliance framework that provides:

✓ Operational Reality

- SAP (externally managed)
- Internal SAP ABAP team (India) available for outbound work
- Valency internal ABAP team to handle **data readiness, field exposure, and outbound queuing** under WML guidance

✓ Business & Compliance Priorities

- FIRS MBS compliance (commercial, debit, credit notes) with room to expand to additional document types under the Professional tier
- Clear auditability and immutable logs
- Zero data exposure to WML (client-hosted architecture)
- Tier-based model (Standard / Professional ✓ / Enterprise)
- Product & customer Master Data upload process
- User licensing clarity
- Integration guide + dictionary for SAP partner
- Sandbox → UAT → Go-Live workflow

✓ What Was Requested

- A fresh discounted proposal
- Full breakdown of scope, technical method, deliverables, pricing, licensing, timelines
- Clear differences between Standard, Professional, Enterprise
- Clarify master data bulk upload
- Provide WML data dictionary
- Provide integration guides for SAP partner
- Clarify middleware location, responsibilities, and support boundaries.

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3. Proposed Solution: Helium™ Client-Hosted Middleware

A secure, lightweight, zero-touch compliance engine deployed within Valency Agro's chosen environment (cloud/on-prem), integrated to SAP via the client's ABAP team.

Core Functionalities

- Full UBL 3.0 schema validation
- FIRS API connectivity (IRN, QR, receipt handling)
- Master-data upload module (product catalogue & customer records)
- Manual Invoice Push API (triggered from SAP by ABAP team)
- Validation logs + response logs
- Immutable audit trails (hash-chained)
- Queueing, retry logic, and error recovery
- Compliance dashboard for Finance & IT teams

WML's **consultation** focuses on:

- Expanded FIRS document types (Professional)
- Designing tax logic for multiple tax categories
- Designing and validating HSN/product mappings
- Strengthening audit trail design and error-handling patterns.

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4. Tier Comparison: Standard / Professional / Enterprise

4.1 Document Types

Tier	Supported FIRS Document Types
Standard	Commercial Invoice, Debit Note, Credit Note (3 types only)
Professional	All Standard + Self-billed Invoice + Any 2 Additional Types (e.g., Contract Notes, Final Settlement, Waybills)*
Enterprise	Full FIRS MBS Document Catalogue (exhaustive)

* Exact additional document types for Valency Agro will be agreed during design, based on their SAP document universe and compliance needs.

4.2 Tax Categories

Tier	Tax Categories Supported
Standard	VAT, WHT only
Professional	VAT, WHT + additional tax elements, surcharges, levies
Enterprise	All tax categories (full coverage)

4.3 Data Depth & Mandatory Fields

Tier	Data Depth	Notes
Standard	26 Mandatory + 5 conditionally mandatory fields	Ideal for smaller datasets
Professional	Extended audit trail fields (line-level notes, narratives)	Requires additional consultancy
Enterprise	Full UBL expansion: additional attribute notes, multi-level audit chains	Best for regulated manufacturing

4.4 Master Data Upload (Product & Customer Catalogs)

Across all tiers, Valency Agro will receive:

- Product Master Data Template
- Customer Master Template
- Bulk import API allowing secure internal upload
- Frequency: Daily / Weekly based on preference

Valency's SAP ABAP team will own **data readiness and enablement**, including the preparation and upload of product and customer master data, with WML providing templates and advisory support.

5. Integration Responsibilities

WML Responsibilities

- Provide integration guide, API documentation, and data dictionary

- Provide FIRS UBL 3.0 mapping sheets
- Design and deploy Helium™ Middleware in Valency's environment
- Implement validation, audit trail, and logging logic within Helium
- Define patterns for **robust, fail-safe invoice queuing**, retries and DLQ handling (to be implemented within SAP/ABAP by Valency's team)
- Support manual invoice push workflow from SAP
- Provide SAP partner onboarding support
- UAT coordination with FIRS
- Provide test endpoints & sandbox support
- Hypercare after go-live
- SLA-based support (per chosen tier)

Valency Agro / SAP Partner (ABAP Team, India) Responsibilities

- **Data readiness & enablement**, including:
  - Exposing all required SAP fields for mapping (via RFC, IDoc, XML, or API)
  - Implementing **robust, fail-safe outbound queuing** of invoices from SAP to Helium, ensuring invoices are never lost, duplicated or dropped
  - Preparing and maintaining product & customer master data files / feeds
- Perform manual/automated push into Helium™ API from SAP, based on internal control policies
- Provide environment credentials and connectivity for Helium deployment
- Provide representatives for UAT
- Supply sample and real invoice payloads for mapping and testing

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6. Implementation Plan & Timeline (6–8 Weeks From First Tranche Payment)

High-Level Phases

S/N	Phase	Duration (Indicative)	Activities
1	Kick-Off & Requirements	Week 1	Mapping confirmation, schema alignment, readiness checks
2	Design & Environment Setup	Week 2–3	Install middleware, configure endpoints, ABAP design session
3	Development & Testing	Week 4–5	Manual push testing, tax logic validation, audit finalization
4	UAT	Week 6	Joint UAT with FIRS, client SAP team
5	Go-Live & Hypercare	Week 7–8	Production deployment + 90-day monitoring

> ***Note:*** *The 6–8 week timeline is measured* ***from the date of receipt of the first tranche (60% mobilization) payment*** *and depends on timely access to SAP resources and data.*

Stop-Gap Compliance (Free Bulk Upload Tool)

To ensure Valency Agro becomes compliant rapidly while Helium is being implemented:

- WML will provide **free stop-gap compliance tools (bulk upload)** that allow Valency to submit invoices to FIRS MBS within approximately **1 week** of engagement.
- These tools are intended as a **temporary bridge** until Helium is fully deployed and integrated with SAP.

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7. Technical Deliverables

Helium™ Middleware Components

- Invoice ingestion API
- Tax validation module
- UBL 3.0 transformer
- IRN/QR generator
- Immutable audit log ledger
- Retry engine & DLQ (Helium side)
- Compliance dashboard
- Master Data bulk-import module

Documentation

- Integration Guide (SAP-focused)
- Data Dictionary
- Message Schemas
- Error Codes & Resolution Guide
- UAT Playbook

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8. Commercials (Professional Tier)

Helium™ Professional Edition – 6-Month Initial Term

Description	Amount (₦)
Implementation (Professional Edition)	**13,500,000**
Maintenance (₦450,000/month × 6 months)	**2,700,000**
Total (6-Month Term)	**16,200,000**

- All prices **exclude VAT**.
- This 6-month term includes implementation plus the first 6 months of maintenance.
- At the end of the initial term, an annual or renewed monthly maintenance arrangement can be agreed, using **₦450,000/month** as the baseline reference for Professional tier support and compliance updates.

Payment Terms:

- **60%** Mobilization (tranche 1)
- **25%** Upon UAT sign-off
- **15%** Upon Go-Live

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9. Security & Compliance Assurance

Helium™ Middleware is architected to ensure maximum compliance integrity with zero data exposure to WestMetro Limited.

Security Capabilities

- TLS 1.3 encrypted communication end-to-end
- AES-256 encryption at rest (if hosted on cloud infrastructure)
- Zero inbound ports required from the public internet
- Immutable audit log ledger (hash-chained for tamper detection)

- Hardened API Gateway enforcing strict authentication
- Role-based access control (RBAC) for Finance, IT & Admin teams
- 7-year audit retention (client-side storage)
- Isolation of environment per client, no shared tenancy

Compliance Alignment

- FIRS MBS Guidelines & UBL 3.0
- ISO 27001-aligned operational controls
- NDPR (2019) data privacy principles
- NITDA 99.9% availability requirement
- WML is a validated FIRS Access Point Provider (APP)

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10. Business Value & ROI

Strategic Benefits

- **Zero ERP Disruption** – no changes to SAP posting logic
- **Zero Vendor Lock-In** – client-hosted; WML does not store your data
- **Highly Predictable Workflows** – Finance team retains full control via manual push
- **Compliance Certainty** – every invoice validated before FIRS transmission
- **Faster Time to Compliance** – free bulk-upload tools provide a stop-gap while Helium goes live

Operational ROI (Indicative)

Value Driver	Outcome	Indicative Impact
Compliance Automation	Eliminates submission errors & penalties	₦3–7M risk avoided annually
Manual Effort Reduction	Simplifies reconciliation & reporting	40–60% reduction in effort
Immutable Logs	Faster audit response	50–70% time savings during audits
Local Hosting	Improved regulatory posture	Stronger NDPR / FIRS alignment

Additional Cost Avoidance:

- Avoids SAP customisation workarounds for every FIRS change (typically ₦8–15M per year in upgrade complications)
- Avoids repeated ERP consultant interventions just to adjust schemas for FIRS updates
- Reduces penalty exposure from late / invalid submissions

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11. Next Steps

To progress with Helium™ Middleware implementation, the following steps are recommended:

Step-by-Step Activation Plan

Step	Action	Responsibility
1	Proposal Review & Internal Alignment	Valency Agro
2	Tier Selection (Standard / Professional / Enterprise)	Valency Agro

Step	Action	Responsibility
3	Execution of Letter of Engagement (LoE)	Valency Agro × WML
4	Mobilization Payment (60%)	Valency Agro
5	Provision of SAP Technical Contact & Environment Details	Valency Agro × SAP Partner
6	Submission of Sample Invoice Payloads for Mapping	Valency Agro × SAP Partner
7	WML Shares Integration Guide + Data Dictionary	WML
8	Kick-Off, Requirements Session & Design	WML × SAP Partner
9	Middleware Deployment & ABAP Integration	WML × SAP Partner (ABAP team)
10	Sandbox Testing → UAT → Sign-Off	WML × Valency Agro
11	Go-Live & Hypercare Commencement	WML

Project Governance

- Dedicated WML Project Manager
- SAP Partner (ABAP team, India) as Technical Liaison
- Weekly report & checkpoint review
- Shared communication channel

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